COMPLAINTAI-BANK

CUSTOMER COMPLAINT REGISTRATION AND RESOLUTION POLICY

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Version: 1.0

Policy Category: Customer Complaint Registration and Resolution

1. Purpose

Objectives

This policy establishes the standard procedure for receiving, registering, acknowledging, classifying, investigating, resolving, escalating, and closing customer complaints. It defines the information that should be collected, how case records should be maintained, the communication expected during review, and the safeguards required to ensure that complaint outcomes are accurate and traceable.

The policy supports consistent customer treatment, clear ownership of cases, appropriate protection of personal information, and a reliable record of actions taken. It distinguishes a complaint from a general enquiry or service request, and distinguishes a registered complaint from an investigated or resolved complaint.

Every status update must reflect the actual state of the case. A complaint must not be described as registered until the record has been successfully saved, assigned, escalated, or resolved unless the corresponding action has actually taken place.

2. Scope

Complaints and stages covered

This policy applies to complaints concerning account services, cards, transfers and remittances, fees and interest, digital banking, authentication, service access, transaction processing, customer information, communication quality, and other supported banking-related services within the ComPlaintAI-Bank workflow.

It covers submission through supported customer channels, initial screening, information collection, complaint registration, acknowledgement, categorization, assignment, investigation, requests for further information, status updates, decisions, corrective actions, customer notification, escalation, reopening, and closure.

A request for information or a routine service transaction may be handled as an enquiry or service request when it does not express dissatisfaction. If the customer expresses dissatisfaction with a service, decision, delay, charge, transaction, or previous response, the interaction should be assessed as a potential complaint. Suspected fraud or an urgent security incident must also follow the applicable protective-reporting process.

3. Definitions

Key terms

Complaint: An expression of dissatisfaction about a product, service, transaction, decision, process, communication, or previous handling, for which the customer seeks an explanation, correction, review, or other response.

Enquiry: A request for information or explanation that does not express dissatisfaction with a service or outcome.

Service Request: A request to perform a routine service action, such as updating information or obtaining a statement, which may be handled separately from a complaint unless dissatisfaction is expressed.

Complaint Record: The structured record containing the complaint description, identifying reference, relevant details, evidence, assigned category, status, actions, communications, and outcome.

Complaint Reference Number: A unique identifier created after a complaint has been successfully registered.

Acknowledgement: A confirmation that the complaint has been received and recorded, including the reference number when available.

Classification: The process of assigning a complaint category, related service, issue type, and any applicable internal priority.

Investigation: The review of available records, customer-provided information, applicable terms, and other authorized evidence to assess the complaint.

Resolution: The outcome or action determined through the authorized review process, which may include an explanation, correction, reversal, refund, further action, or a decision that no change is required.

Escalation: The referral of a complaint to a more specialized, senior, or otherwise designated review process according to the applicable procedure.

Closure: The recorded end of the current complaint-handling process after required actions and communications have been completed or the permitted closure conditions have been met.

Reopening: The controlled reactivation or further review of a previously closed complaint where new information, an incomplete action, or another valid reason requires attention.

4. Complaint Submission Channels and Accessibility

4.1 Supported channels

Complaints may be received through the customer channels enabled for the service, which may include an online form, digital banking interface, authorized customer-support channel, email, telephone, or another documented intake route. The available channels should be communicated clearly and kept consistent with the actual service capability.

A channel must not be represented as available if it is not configured or monitored. If a customer contacts an unsupported channel, the response should provide an appropriate available route where known, rather than implying that the complaint has been registered.

4.2 Accessibility and assisted submission

Complaint submission should use clear language and avoid requiring unnecessary technical knowledge. Where assistance is available, a customer who has difficulty completing a form should be guided through the required fields without changing the meaning of the complaint.

If the complaint is submitted on behalf of a customer, the intake process should establish whether the person is authorized to act for the customer where such verification is required. A family relationship or possession of basic account details should not automatically be treated as authority to access another person's private information.

4.3 Urgent safety and fraud issues

Complaints involving a lost or stolen card, suspected unauthorized access, active fraud, compromised credentials, or a transfer that may require urgent protective action should be directed to the relevant security or transaction-reporting process promptly.

Registration of a general complaint should not delay an urgent block, credential-protection request, or authorized payment recovery attempt. Any action claimed as completed must be supported by confirmation from the relevant system or responsible team.

5. Information Required at Intake

5.1 Core complaint details

A complaint should capture the following information where relevant and available:

1. Customer name or the identifying information required by the authorized verification process.
2. A safe contact method for acknowledgements and follow-up.
3. The service or product affected, such as account, card, transfer, digital access, fee, or another service.
4. A clear description of what happened and why the customer is dissatisfied.
5. The approximate date and time of the event, request, transaction, or previous interaction.
6. The amount and currency, merchant or beneficiary, transaction reference, case reference, or other identifier where relevant.
7. The outcome requested by the customer, such as an explanation, review, correction, refund, or status update.
8. Supporting documents or evidence available to the customer, where needed and appropriate.

Missing details should be recorded as unknown or not provided rather than guessed. A complaint should not be unnecessarily blocked because a customer does not know an internal reference, provided enough information exists to create a useful record and the process permits registration.

5.2 Data minimization and sensitive information

Only information reasonably needed to identify, verify, route, and investigate the complaint should be collected. Customers must not be asked to include passwords, PINs, one-time passcodes, CVVs, or other authentication secrets in the complaint narrative or supporting file.

Where a customer includes unnecessary sensitive information, access should be limited and the information should be handled under the applicable data-protection procedure. A copy of the complaint should not be redistributed more broadly than required for its resolution.

5.3 Clarification before registration

If the description is unclear, the intake process may request a focused clarification, such as which transaction is affected or what outcome the customer is seeking. Questions should be limited to what is necessary to understand and record the issue.

Where the complaint can already be recorded, missing non-essential details should be requested during investigation rather than used as a reason to imply that no complaint has been received. The system should accurately distinguish a draft or incomplete submission from a successfully registered complaint.

6. Registration, Acknowledgement and Reference Numbers

6.1 Registration conditions

A complaint is registered only after the required complaint record has been successfully created in the designated storage system. The record should contain a unique reference, submission timestamp, complaint description, available customer and service details, initial category, and status.

If saving fails, the interface must not display a success confirmation or fabricate a reference number. The customer should be informed that registration could not be confirmed and given the available retry or support route. The system should handle duplicate submission attempts carefully to reduce accidental duplicate records.

6.2 Unique reference number

Each successfully registered complaint should receive a unique and retrievable reference number. The reference should be associated with the stored case record and used for status enquiries, additional evidence, escalation, and related communication.

The reference format may be generated by the project's configured identifier scheme, provided uniqueness is maintained. A reference number is evidence of record creation only; it does not mean that the complaint has been accepted on its merits, investigated, escalated externally, or resolved.

6.3 Acknowledgement content

The acknowledgement should confirm that the complaint has been recorded, provide the reference number, summarize the issue category where appropriate, explain how the customer can refer to the case, and indicate what happens next according to the actual workflow.

An acknowledgement should not include internal priority scores, model confidence values, security signals, private staff notes, or unsupported resolution dates. If further information is needed, the message should identify the requested information and the authorized way to provide it.

6.4 Registration timestamps and duplicate records

The system should record the actual time a complaint was successfully received or saved, using a consistent timestamp convention. Any displayed local time should be derived consistently from the stored timestamp and the applicable presentation settings.

Where repeated submissions appear to concern the same event, the records may be linked or reviewed for duplication under the configured process. A new complaint must not be merged into an existing record solely because the wording is similar if it concerns a different transaction or a new unresolved issue.

7. Categorization and Assignment

7.1 Complaint classification

Complaints should be categorized by the main service and the issue described. Categories may include account management, debit or credit cards, unauthorized transactions, transfers and remittances, fees and interest, digital banking, authentication, service access, refund requests, or general complaint handling.

Classification should be based on the customer's stated issue and the available evidence. Where one complaint covers several linked matters, the record should identify the primary issue and note other affected services so they are not lost during assignment.

7.2 Assisted or automated classification

Automated text classification may be used to recommend a complaint category, but the predicted category should be treated as a decision aid rather than conclusive evidence. Where the predicted intent conflicts with the complaint description, the discrepancy should be reviewed under the configured procedure.

The system should preserve the complaint narrative and relevant extracted entities separately from its classification result. It should not silently rewrite the customer's complaint to fit a model label.

7.3 Assignment and ownership

Each registered complaint should be assigned to the configured responsible queue, team, or case owner where the workflow supports assignment. Assignment records should identify the destination and the date or time the assignment occurred.

A case should not be described as escalated or assigned to a specialist unless the assignment event was successfully recorded or otherwise confirmed. If the project uses only an internal queue and has no external integration, the customer-facing language must not imply that a real external department has received the complaint.

7.4 Reclassification

A complaint may be reclassified when further information reveals a different primary issue or when the original categorization was incorrect. The reason for a material category or assignment change should be recorded so that the history of the case remains understandable.

Reclassification should not erase earlier activity or alter the original complaint description. Any changed category should be used for subsequent investigation and reporting once the change has been recorded.

8. Investigation and Evidence Management

8.1 Investigation plan

The responsible reviewer should identify the question to be answered, the records needed, the applicable service terms, the events alleged by the customer, and any outstanding information. The scope should be proportionate to the issue and should distinguish factual questions from the remedy requested.

The investigation may include reviewing transaction records, account or service history available to authorized personnel, fee schedules, confirmation messages, previous correspondence, supporting documents, and relevant policy passages. Only authorized evidence sources should be accessed.

8.2 Evidence quality and source tracking

Evidence should be relevant to the complaint, readable where possible, and associated with the correct case and transaction. The case record should identify whether a fact comes from the customer's statement, an uploaded document, a system record, an applicable policy, or another authorized source.

Where information conflicts, the reviewer should record the discrepancy and seek clarification where appropriate. A model prediction, extracted entity, or automatically generated summary must not be treated as verified transaction evidence without checking the underlying source.

8.3 Requests for additional information

If more information is necessary, the customer should receive a clear request specifying what is needed, why it is relevant where appropriate, and how it should be submitted securely. The request should avoid asking for authentication secrets or unnecessary personal data.

The case record should note the request and any response received. Where the customer cannot provide an item, the reviewer should assess the evidence that remains and determine the next step under the applicable process rather than assume that the allegation is true or false solely because the item is missing.

8.4 Investigation notes

Investigation notes should be factual, relevant, professional, and limited to information necessary for the case. They should record important checks, findings, consultations, decisions, open questions, and actions taken.

Speculation, insulting descriptions, unsupported conclusions, or unnecessary sensitive information should not be included. Corrections to material notes should preserve an appropriate audit trail.

9. Customer Communication and Status Updates

9.1 Status accuracy

Case statuses should describe the actual stage of handling, such as received, registered, awaiting information, under review, assigned, action pending, resolved, or closed, where those statuses are implemented by the workflow.

Status names must be defined consistently and must not be used interchangeably. For example, a case that has been saved but not examined should not be presented as investigated, and a request sent to another queue should not be presented as a completed remedy.

9.2 Clear and respectful updates

Customer communications should use plain language and explain what has happened, what is still being reviewed, whether the customer needs to act, and what the next confirmed step is. The reference number should be included where it helps the customer identify the case.

Updates should avoid unexplained technical terminology, internal model labels, priority scores, confidence values, staff-only notes, or statements about hidden security processes. The information shared must comply with applicable privacy and disclosure requirements.

9.3 Timeframes and expectations

A response or resolution timeframe may be communicated only when supported by a documented service commitment, an applicable procedure, or confirmed case-specific information. If no supported timeframe is available, the communication should explain that the case is under review without inventing a deadline.

An estimated timeframe should be distinguished from a guarantee. If a previously communicated target changes, the customer should receive an updated explanation where the workflow requires it and the reason can be disclosed.

9.4 Communication failures

If an acknowledgement or update cannot be delivered, the case should retain the correct status and record the failed attempt where that capability is available. The system must not assume that an email, SMS, or notification was received merely because it was created or queued.

Where contact details appear incorrect, the customer should be directed through an authorized process to update them. Sensitive case details should not be sent to an unverified destination.

10. Resolution, Corrective Action and Customer Outcome

10.1 Resolution assessment

The resolution should address the complaint issue and be based on available evidence, applicable terms, and an authorized decision. Possible outcomes may include providing an explanation, correcting a record, reversing an error, processing an approved refund, restoring a service, requesting further information, or determining that no corrective action is supported.

The existence of a complaint does not itself establish that an error occurred or that a refund is due. Equally, an initial automated classification should not decide the merits of a complaint without the required review.

10.2 Action authorization

Any financial adjustment, account change, transaction reversal, service restoration, or other material remedy must follow the authorization and operational controls applicable to that action. The complaint record should capture the action, its reference where available, and the confirmed status.

The customer must not be told that a remedy has been completed when it has only been recommended, approved but not processed, submitted for processing, or placed in a queue. Communications should reflect the actual stage and identify any remaining dependency.

10.3 Decision explanation

The outcome communication should state the decision in clear terms, summarize the basis for it to the extent permitted, identify any completed corrective action, and explain any available next step or escalation route.

If the complaint is not upheld or only partly upheld, the explanation should be specific enough to address the issue raised without disclosing private information, restricted controls, or information about other customers. It should not use generic wording as a substitute for a reasoned response where case facts are available.

10.4 Partial resolution and outstanding issues

Where a complaint contains multiple issues, a remedy for one issue does not automatically resolve all others. Each material issue should have a clear status, and any outstanding matter should be identified before the overall case is closed.

If the customer needs to take further action, the instruction should be clearly stated. The case record should preserve which issues are resolved and which remain open.

11. Escalation, Reopening and Unresolved Complaints

11.1 Reasons for escalation

Escalation may be appropriate where a complaint is complex, remains unresolved, involves a material service failure, requires specialist authority, presents a continuing risk, or is challenged by the customer under the applicable process.

The reason for escalation, destination, time, and actual status should be recorded. Escalation does not guarantee a different decision or outcome, and the customer should not be told that the case has reached another team unless that transfer is confirmed.

11.2 Customer-requested review

Where the customer disagrees with the decision, the complaint process should identify any available review or escalation route and explain how the customer can refer to the original case. Any relevant new information should be linked to the case or recorded according to the process.

A review should consider the grounds raised and any new relevant evidence, while preserving the original decision and case history. The person or process conducting the review should have the authority required by the applicable procedure.

11.3 Reopening a case

A closed complaint may be reopened where new evidence is received, a promised corrective action was not completed, a material issue was omitted, or the applicable process otherwise permits further review.

The reopening reason and date should be recorded, along with the connection to the previous reference number. The case should be assigned for the required follow-up and the customer should receive an updated status if the communication process requires it.

11.4 Unresolved or externally dependent cases

If resolution depends on information, processing, or a decision outside the current workflow, the case should identify the dependency and the last confirmed status. The customer should be told only what can be verified.

A case should not be falsely marked resolved solely because responsibility has been referred elsewhere or because no further action is available within the current system. Closure must follow the defined closure criteria and retain any outstanding limitation in the record where appropriate.

12. Closure Criteria and Post-Resolution Review

12.1 Closure requirements

A complaint may be closed when the investigation or permitted handling process is complete, the outcome has been recorded, material required actions are complete or properly accounted for, the customer has been informed where required, and any available review route has been communicated.

A complaint should not be closed only because a reference number was generated, a case was assigned, a status message was sent, or a period of time elapsed. If required actions remain outstanding, the case should remain open or carry a status that accurately reflects the dependency.

12.2 Closure confirmation

The closure message should identify the complaint reference, summarize the outcome, confirm actions that actually occurred, and explain any next step permitted by the procedure. If no action was taken, the communication should not imply that a correction or refund was processed.

Where the customer asks a status question after closure, the response should use the saved record and should not infer that the case remains open or has been reopened unless such a change is recorded.

12.3 Quality review and learning

Complaint records may be reviewed to identify repeated service problems, unclear policy content, recurring transaction issues, routing errors, or communication gaps. Review findings should be based on reliable records and should not expose personal data beyond the authorized purpose.

Any corrective process or knowledge-base update identified through review should be tracked through the relevant governance process. A pattern in complaint text may indicate an issue for further examination but should not be treated as proof of wrongdoing without verification.

13. Customer Responsibilities and Data Protection

13.1 Customer responsibilities

Customers are expected to:

1. Describe the issue accurately and identify the affected product or transaction where possible.
2. Provide relevant dates, amounts, references, and supporting information when available.
3. Use authorized channels for complaints involving sensitive account or personal information.
4. Avoid including passwords, PINs, OTPs, CVVs, or other authentication secrets.
5. Respond to reasonable, relevant requests for additional information.
6. Retain the complaint reference and important case communications.
7. Notify the service if relevant contact details change or new information materially affects the case.
8. Review the outcome and use the available escalation process if dissatisfied.

13.2 Personal information and restricted access

Personal, account, transaction, contact, and complaint information should be collected and used only for authorized registration, verification, investigation, resolution, service monitoring, and other permitted purposes. Access should be limited according to role and operational need.

Complaint data should be protected against unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, loss, or misuse. Sensitive information should not be included in general reporting where it is not necessary, and disclosures should follow applicable requirements.

13.3 Retention and auditability

Complaint records, evidence, status changes, communications, and decisions should be retained according to applicable legal, contractual, regulatory, and organizational requirements. Retention periods must not be invented where no documented rule is available.

Material changes should be traceable, and authorized users should be able to establish the sequence of registration, assignment, investigation, decision, corrective action, and closure. Corrections to records should preserve appropriate accountability.

14. Exceptions, System Integrity and Policy Review

14.1 Exceptions and interpretation

Specific complaint response times, compensation rules, escalation rights, evidence requirements, and resolution standards may be established by product terms or a separate complaint-handling procedure. This policy does not create a universal deadline or guarantee a particular outcome.

If available policy material does not establish a detail, the detail must not be invented or presented as confirmed. The case should be referred to an authorized source or reviewer where clarification is required.

14.2 ComPlaintAI-Bank workflow controls

The ComPlaintAI-Bank system may collect a complaint through its interface, classify it, extract relevant entities, store it, assign it to an internal queue, and produce a confirmation based on the configured workflow. The system may confirm successful registration only after the database save succeeds and a reference is available.

The system must not claim that a complaint was sent to a real external department, that a financial transaction was reversed, that a refund was paid, or that a service was restored unless the connected authorized system confirms the action. If only an internal queue is used, customer-facing messages must describe that limited action accurately.

Automated intent classification, entity extraction, policy retrieval, and generated summaries are decision-support functions. They should not override verified evidence, invent missing complaint details, or make a final decision where an authorized human or operational process is required.

14.3 Policy review

This policy should be reviewed when complaint channels, data fields, classification logic, case storage, assignment processes, resolution procedures, or applicable requirements change. The language and status names used in the knowledge base and application should remain consistent.

Related policies include Account Management and Banking Services Policy; Debit and Credit Card Services Policy; Fraud, Unauthorized Transactions and Disputes Policy; Fund Transfers, Remittances and Refunds Policy; Banking Fees, Charges and Interest Policy; Digital Banking and Authentication Policy; Customer Complaint Registration and Resolution Policy; and Complaint Priority, Department Routing and Data Privacy Policy.

End of Policy